# Lan E. Luo

*Last updated October 28, 2026*

Yale School of Management
Yale University
165 Whitney Avenue
New Haven, CT 06511

Evans Hall 5467
+1 (203) 432-6521
lan.luo@yale.edu
www.laneluo.com

## Academic Appointments

**Yale School of Management**, *Yale University*
Assistant Professor of Marketing — Jul 2026–Present

**Center for Algorithms, Data, and Market Design**, *Yale University*
Faculty Fellow — Oct 2026–Present

## Education

**Columbia University**
Ph.D. Marketing — 2026
*Committee: Olivier Toubia, Oded Netzer, Asim Ansari, Andrey Simonov, Ryan Dew*
M.Phil. Marketing — 2024

**Yale University**
B.A. Economics; B.A. Statistics & Data Science (Honors) — 2020

## Research Interests

**Substantive**: Data-Driven Design, User-Generated Content, Digital Advertising, Social Issues

**Methodological**: Interpretable Machine Learning, Applied Econometrics, Probabilistic Machine Learning, Causal Inference, Deep Generative Modeling

## Journal Publications

Frontiers: Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation
**Lan E. Luo** and Olivier Toubia
*Marketing Science, 2026*

Probabilistic Machine Learning: New Frontiers for Modeling Consumers and their Choices
Ryan Dew, Nicolas Padilla, **Lan E. Luo**, Shin Oblander, Asim Ansari, Khaled Boughanmi, Michael Braun, Fred Feinberg, Jia Liu, Thomas Otter, Longxiu Tian, Yixin Wang, and Mingzhang Yin
*International Journal of Research in Marketing, 2026*

Public attitudes value interpretability but prioritize accuracy in Artificial Intelligence
Anne-Marie Nussberger, **Lan Luo**, L. Elisa Celis, and Molly J. Crockett
*Nature Communications, 2022*

## Working Papers

How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design
**Lan E. Luo**
*Draft available upon request*

## Works in Progress *(* indicates equal authorship)*

Theory-Guided AI Conversations as Flexible Choice Architecture: Evidence from Retirement Benefit Claiming
Daniel Russman*, **Lan E. Luo***, Alisa Wu*, and Eric J. Johnson

Sparse Autoencoders Reveal (and Generate) the Drivers of Online Sharing
Reed Orchinik*, **Lan E. Luo***

How Livestreaming Chats Engage Consumers
**Lan E. Luo***, Eric S. Park*

Causality in Conversations
Ryan Dew*, Yu Ding*, **Lan E. Luo***

AI-Powered Conjoint Analysis
Ryan Dew, **Lan E. Luo**

## Invited Seminar Talks *(includes scheduled talks)*

| | |
|---|---|
| Shidler College of Business, University of Hawaii at Manoa | May 2027 |
| Booth School of Business, University of Chicago | Feb 2027 |
| SC Johnson Graduate School of Management, Cornell University | Nov 2026 |
| The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania | Oct 2025 |
| C. T. Bauer College of Business, University of Houston | Oct 2025 |
| Yale School of Management | Oct 2025 |
| Tuck School of Business, Dartmouth College | Oct 2025 |
| Lee Kong Chian School of Business, Singapore Management University | Sep 2025 |
| NUS Business School, National University of Singapore | Sep 2025 |
| INSEAD | Sep 2025 |
| Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia | Sep 2025 |
| McCombs School of Business, University of Texas at Austin | Aug 2025 |

## Conference & Workshop Presentations *(includes scheduled presentations)*

Amazon Science Seminar, Online — Nov 2026
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Virtual Quantitative Marketing Seminar, Online — Oct 2026
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Thirteenth Triennial Choice Symposium, University of Colorado Boulder, Vail, Colorado — Aug 2026
– *Seeing Choice: Visual Cues and Decision-Making*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Nova School of Business and Economics, Carcavelos, Portugal — Jun 2026
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

GenAI Lab, Technical University of Munich, Online — Jan 2026
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics, Columbia University, New York — Dec 2025
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

GenAI in Marketing & Advertising Roundtable, Meta, New York — Nov 2025
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Georgia, Washington, D.C. — Jun 2025
– *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, UNSW Sydney, Australia — Jun 2024
– *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Symposium on Artificial Intelligence in Marketing, University of Wisconsin–Madison — May 2024
– *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Twelfth Triennial Choice Symposium, INSEAD, Fontainebleau, France — Aug 2023
– *Probabilistic Machine Learning for Scalable, Flexible, and Interpretable Models of Choice*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Miami, Florida — Jun 2023
– *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

## Awards & Honors

| | |
|---|---|
| Finalist, American Statistical Association's Marketing Dissertation Award | 2026 |
| AMA-Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium Fellow | 2025 |
| Columbia Experimental Laboratory in the Social Sciences Travel Grant | 2024 |
| W. Edwards Deming Center Doctoral Fellowship | 2023 |
| Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Doctoral Research Grant | 2022 |
| Don Lehmann Scholar Award | 2020 |
| Yale Hartigan Undergraduate Senior Thesis Prize for Statistics & Data Science | 2020 |

## Teaching

**Yale School of Management**

Generative AI and Social Media (MGT 575, MBA) — Spring 2027

## Academic Service *(includes scheduled service)*

**Conference Discussant**

– Discussant, "Platforms and Digital Economy," Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting, American Economic Association, January 2027

**Conference Session Organization**

– Session Co-Organizer, "Generative AI for Marketing Measurement, Experimentation, and Design," ISMS Marketing Science Conference, June 2026

## Industry Experience

Analysis Group, *Summer Analyst Intern* 2019

## Skills

**Languages**: English (native); Mandarin, French (proficient); Korean, Japanese (basic)
**Programming**: Python, R (fluent); Stata, Stan, Mathematica, Java, SQL (familiar)